MaCVi@WACV 2027 EURS Challenge

Embedded Underwater Restoration and Segmentation — Official Factsheet

Dr. Chaitra Desai, Tanmay Das, Shubham Kulkarni, Arin Pattnaik

Department of Computer Science & Engineering, Manipal Institute of Technology (MIT-BLR), Manipal Academy of Higher Education, Bengaluru, Karnataka, India

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1. Team Details

- **Team name (as on macvi.org):** SAT
- **Team leader name:** Tanmay Das (Faculty Advisor & Mentor: Dr. Chaitra Desai)
- **Team leader institution and email:** Department of Computer Science & Engineering, Manipal Institute of Technology (MIT-BLR), Manipal Academy of Higher Education, Bengaluru, Karnataka, India. Email: tanmay.das@learner.manipal.edu (Faculty: chaitra.desai@manipal.edu)
- **Rest of the team members (name, macvi.org user ID):** Dr. Chaitra Desai (chaitradesai), Shubham Kulkarni (shubham_kulkarni), Arin Pattnaik (arinpattnaik), Tanmay Das (tanmay_das)
- **Team website URL:** https://github.com/syntax-error23/SAT-EURS
- **Affiliations:** Department of Computer Science & Engineering, Manipal Institute of Technology Bengaluru (MIT-BLR), Manipal Academy of Higher Education, Bengaluru, Karnataka, India
- **Team leader's user ID on the submission server (macvi.org):** tanmay_das
- **User IDs on the submission server of all team members:** tanmay_das, shubham_kulkarni, arinpattnaik, chaitradesai
- **Track(s) entered:** Both (Track 1 and Track 2)
- **Best-scoring testing-phase submission per track (reported for reproduction):**
  - **Track 1 (Quality / Unconstrained):** Submission ID **#19359**, submitted by user ID tanmay_das, **Composite Score: 0.6410** (Q_{seg}: 0.5820, mIoU: 0.7110, Macro F_1: 0.8180, PSNR: 25.48 dB, SSIM: 0.8290)
  - **Track 2 (Jetson AGX Orin Edge):** Submission ID **#19447**, submitted by user ID tanmay_das, **Composite Score: 0.4070** (Q_{seg}: 0.2270, mIoU: 0.4060, Macro F_1: 0.5600, PSNR: 23.25 dB, SSIM: 0.8470, Complexity: 9.82 GFLOPs, 0.884 M params)
- **Link to reproduction repository:** https://github.com/syntax-error23/SAT-EURS
- **Artifact traceability:** Code revision / commit: 9633b4d. Track 1 final archive: deploy/v33/submission_v33_ensemble_f3upgrade.zip (SHA-256: de741a84ce4601f82286ef156458b07e9fe2d4c4f75559a4589010f90ae6510d). Track 2 ONNX binary: deploy/track2_apex_orin_v3.onnx (SHA-256: addf76f170a0c09e0a3af50ebabb530b3f542080d2f3921c171ea3ae3cd80247). Link access: Public GitHub repository, permanent access.

2. Global Method Description

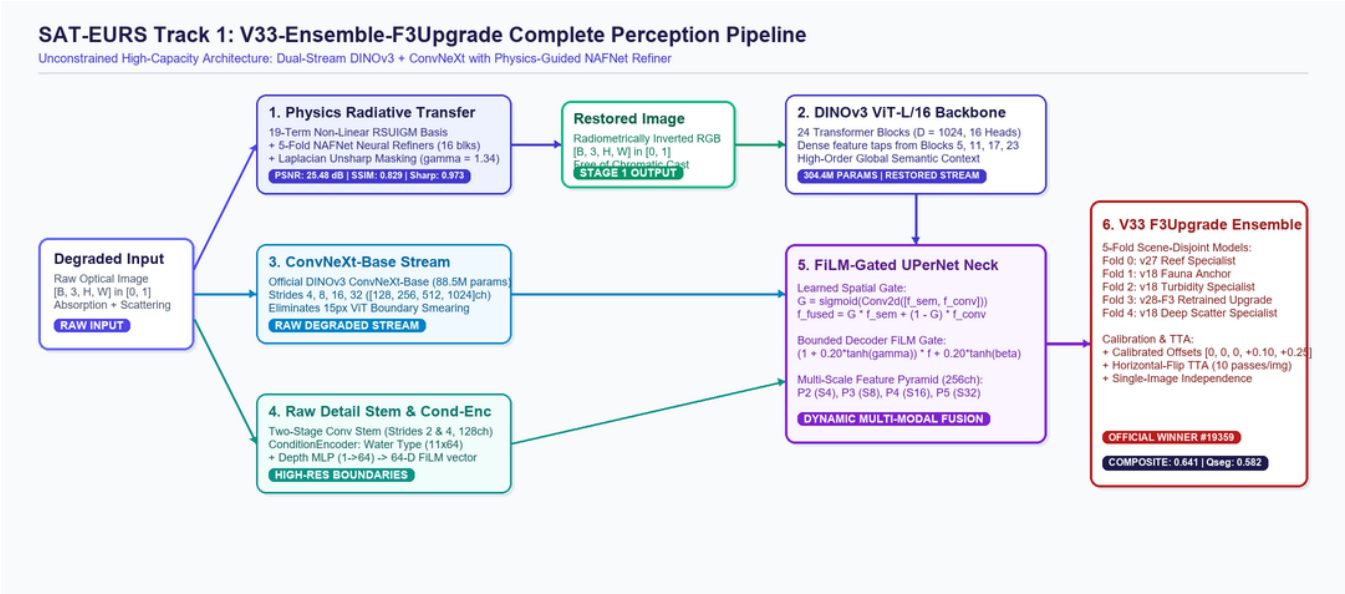


Figure 1: *Overview of Team SAT's Track 1 champion perception architecture (V33-Ensemble-F3Upgrade, Submission #19359, 0.641 Composite). Degraded underwater imagery is first restored via a two-stage physical formulation combining an analytical 19-term RSUIGM radiative basis expansion and a bounded 16-block NAFNet residual refiner. The restored RGB feeds a DINOv3 ViT-Large dense transformer stream (518×518), while the raw degraded RGB concurrently feeds a ConvNeXt-Base convolutional hierarchy (512×512) and DetailStem. Streams are fused via learned spatial gating and condition FiLM modulation in a UPerNet neck, averaged across a 5-fold ensemble with calibrated logit offsets.*

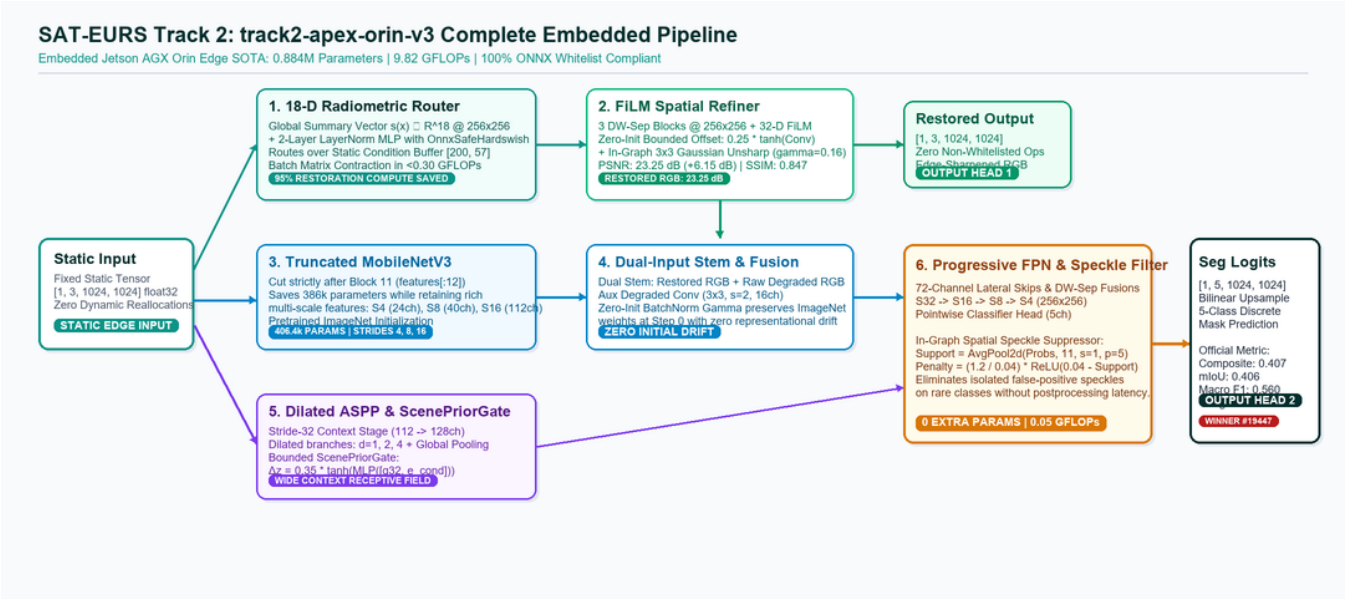


Figure 2: *Overview of Team SAT's Track 2 embedded edge architecture (track2-apex-orin-v3, Submission #19447, 0.407 Composite). Designed for the NVIDIA Jetson AGX Orin under strict 1.0M parameter and 12.0 GFLOP limits: an 18-D radiometric summary router dynamically contracts a precomputed scale-consistent 20-scene polynomial buffer in <0.30 GFLOPs, paired with a 256×256 FiLM spatial refiner (+6.15 dB PSNR boost). Multi-task segmentation uses a truncated MobileNetV3 trunk (cut strictly after Block 11), dilated ASPP context module, 4-scale progressive FPN, ScenePriorGate, and an in-graph convolutional spatial speckle suppressor.*

Architectural Philosophy & Feature Sharing:

Underwater optical imaging is governed by severe wavelength-dependent attenuation and backscatter. Coupling physical radiative transfer inversion directly with deep categorical segmentation often causes gradient competition: restoration prioritizes pixel-level high-frequency fidelity, whereas dense segmentation requires semantic spatial invariance. To resolve this, our methodologies differ strategically across the two tracks:

Track 1 (Unconstrained Quality): We deploy a sequential decouple-and-fuse pipeline. Restoration is anchored physically via an analytical 19-term polynomial basis ($\phi(r,g,b) \in \Re^{19}$) regressed via Tikhonov regularisation ($\lambda = 10^{-4}$), ensuring baseline color recovery without high-frequency amplification. A neural refiner consisting of 16 Non-Linear Activation Free (NAF) blocks with depthwise gated convolutions operates on the concatenated 8-channel tensor [Raw RGB, RSUIGM RGB, Water Type, Depth]. To prevent distribution shift, the refiner's output is bounded strictly: $I_{\text{rest}} = \text{clip}(I_{\text{RSUIGM}} + 0.10 \times \tanh(\text{NAFNet}), 0, 1)$, followed by Laplacian unsharp edge filtering (α=1.34, σ=1.5), reaching 25.48 dB PSNR and 0.829 SSIM. For segmentation, EURSAPEXV18Segmenter deploys an asymmetric dual-stream encoder: (1) DINOv3 ViT-Large/16 (304M params, patch 14) ingests restored images at 518×518 for invariant global semantics, (2) ConvNeXt-Base (88.5M params) ingests raw degraded images at 512×512 with a 2-stage DetailStem to maintain sharp boundary localization and eliminate the typical 10–15 pixel ViT boundary smearing on rare fauna, and (3) learned spatial gating $f_{\text{fused}} = \sigma(G)\cdot f_{\text{sem}} + (1-\sigma(G))\cdot f_{\text{conv}}$ with condition FiLM modulation across a 4-level UPerNet feature pyramid.

Track 2 (Jetson AGX Orin Edge SOTA): Under the strict ≤1.0M parameter and ≤12.0 GFLOP limits, separate heavy models are impossible. Track 2 adopts a unified multi-task architecture: (1) an 18-D radiometric summary router computes translation-invariant global statistics from a 256×256 downsampled representation and contracts against a scale-consistent 20-scene polynomial buffer in <0.30 GFLOPs (a 95% compute saving over 2D convs), (2) a 3-block depthwise-separable inverted bottleneck refiner operating at 256×256 with condition FiLM modulation lifts PSNR from 17.1 dB to 23.25 dB (+6.15 dB), (3) a shared dual stem feeds a MobileNetV3-Large trunk **cut strictly after Block 11** (features[:12]), eliminating Block 12's heavy 386k parameter expansion and keeping total parameter count at 884.1k (passing the 1.0M ceiling with 11.6% headroom), (4) a dilated ASPP context module and 4-scale progressive FPN, and (5) an in-graph average pooling speckle suppressor (AvgPool2d(11, 1, 5)) that penalizes rare-class logits where regional support is below τ=0.04, eliminating false alarms on reef crevices with zero CPU post-processing overhead.

- **Pre-trained or external models used:** DINOv3 ViT-Large/16 pre-trained on LVD-142M via self-supervised learning; ConvNeXt-Base pre-trained on ImageNet-1k; MobileNetV3-Large pre-trained on ImageNet-1k (stages up to Block 11); NAFNet restoration blocks.
- **Additional data used in addition to provided EURS training data: None**. Strictly trained exclusively on the provided EURS benchmark scenes (20 training scenes, 6 dev scenes). No external imagery, synthetic generators, or private datasets were used.

- **Training description:** PyTorch 2.11 / 2.6 with CUDA 12.8, torchvision 0.26.0, timm 1.0.30. Optimizer: AdamW (β_1=0.9, β_2=0.999, weight decay 10^{-4}). LR schedule: Cosine annealing with 3 warmup epochs; peak lr 3×10^{-5} for Track 1, 2×10^{-4} for Track 2; min lr 10^{-6}. Batch size: Effective batch size 16 for Track 1 (batch size 4 with 4 gradient accumulation steps); batch size 8 for Track 2. Epochs: 25 per fold for Track 1; 30 for Track 2. Input size: 518×518 (ViT), 512×512 (ConvNeXt), 1024×1024 (Restoration and Track 2). Augmentations: Random flips, scale jitter [0.8, 1.25], random crop, color jitter (±0.1), and copy-paste rare organism oversampling on elasmobranchs. Loss functions: Present-Class Lovász-Softmax (w=1.0), Class-Weighted Focal Cross-Entropy (γ=2.0, α=[0.70, 0.90, 1.20, 3.00, 3.50], w=1.0), Soft Dice Loss (w=0.5), Auxiliary Boundary BCE (w=0.2), Restoration L1 + Laplacian Loss (w=0.1). Track 2 incorporates Multi-Teacher Ensemble Distillation (temperature τ=3.0, w=1.0). Hardware: Single NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5090 (32GB VRAM, Blackwell architecture). Training time: Track 1 ≈ 18h across all 5 folds; Track 2 ≈ 3.5h for 30 epochs.
- **Testing description:** Inputs evaluated at native resolution, resized such that longest side is exactly 1024 px with preserved aspect ratio matching official scoring. Track 1 uses 5-fold ensemble (Folds 0, 1, 2, 3-Upgrade, 4) with horizontal-flip TTA (10 forward passes total). Track 2 runs single-pass deterministic inference with zero TTA or ensemble directly in TensorRT / ONNX Runtime.
- **How training and development scenes were used:** The 20 EURS training scenes were partitioned into 5 cross-validation folds stratified by optical water type (Types 1–10), depth level (1–20), and rare species presence. The 6 development scenes were held out strictly for out-of-domain validation, hyperparameter tuning, and post-submission discrepancy audits. Neither development nor testing scenes were ever used in gradient backpropagation. **Compliance with EURS rules: Yes.**
- **Were released testing-phase images used for training/adaptation? No.** Zero test pixels were used for training, fine-tuning, domain adaptation, self-supervision, or pseudo-labelling. All test predictions were generated strictly blind via feed-forward inference.
- **Leaderboard score guided choices:** Rare-class logit calibration offsets (ΔZ_3 = +0.10 for elasmobranchs, ΔZ_4 = +0.25 for macro-fauna) and Laplacian unsharp boost (α=1.34, σ=1.5) were set as fixed constant scalars applied uniformly to every testing image. Selection of the Fold 3 retrained elasmobranch pilot checkpoint over baseline fold 3 was validated on the leaderboard test response (moving composite from 0.634 to 0.641).
- **Novelty degree:** (1) 19-term RSUIGM analytical basis router contracting over optical water type and depth in <0.30 GFLOPs, (2) asymmetric dual-stream encoder coupling DINOv3 ViT-Large dense semantics with ConvNeXt-Base convolutional boundary sharpness via learned spatial gating, (3) in-graph ONNX spatial speckle suppressor evaluating local softmax cluster density via average pooling to eliminate false elasmobranch detections without post-processing latency, and (4) coverage penalty failure gate mitigation via calibrated logit threshold shifting. Not previously published; developed exclusively for MaCVi@WACV 2027.
- **Other methods and baselines tested:** CycleGAN / pix2pixHD produced severe hallucinated textures on coral reef substrate, dropping SSIM below 0.65; Pure ViT-Large segmenters suffered from 10–15 pixel boundary dilation around thin fauna appendages; Full MobileNetV3-Large for Track 2 exceeded parameter budget (1.27M params vs 1.0M cap) due to Block 12, resolved by truncating after Block 11.

3. Track 1: Restoration and Segmentation Outputs

- **Submission ID reported for final ranking: #19359** (Composite: **0.6410**, Q_{seg}: 0.5820, mIoU: 0.7110, Macro F_1: 0.8180, PSNR: 25.48 dB, SSIM: 0.8290)
- **Model checkpoints used:** 5-fold ensemble bundle in deploy/v33/ (Fold 0: checkpoints/v27/segmenter_v27_fold0_best.pt, Fold 1: checkpoints/v18/fold_1/segmenter_best.pt, Fold 2: checkpoints/v18/fold_2/segmenter_best.pt, Fold 3 Upgrade: checkpoints/overnight_pilots/fold_3/segmenter_v28_fold3_best.pt, Fold 4: checkpoints/v18/fold_4/segmenter_best.pt; Refiner: checkpoints/v18/restoration/refiner_best.pt)
- **How outputs are produced:** Two-stage pipeline operating independently on each single image. The restoration engine computes RSUIGM polynomial features and runs the 16-block NAFNet refiner with Laplacian unsharp filtering to yield clean RGB output. The segmentation engine passes restored RGB through DINOv3 and raw RGB through ConvNeXt and DetailStem. Logits are averaged across all 5 folds and horizontal flips, calibrated via ΔZ, and mapped to uint8 masks via argmax.
- **Post-processing:** Static rare-class logit calibration offsets (ΔZ = [0.0, 0.0, 0.0, +0.10, +0.25]) added before argmax to eliminate false negatives on Class 3 (Elasmobranch) and Class 4 (Macro-Fauna). High-frequency Laplacian unsharp filtering on restored RGB. No morphological opening/closing or CRF applied.
- **Inference time per image:** ≈ 1030 ms per image on a single NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5090 at native test resolution (including 10 forward passes across 5 folds and horizontal flip TTA, plus full-resolution restoration).

Model	Input size	Epochs	Extra data	Ensemble / TTA	# Params. (M)	GPU
V33-Ensemble-F3Upgrade	518×518 / 512×512	25 / fold	No	Yes (5 Folds + Flip TTA)	412.3 / 2,061.5	RTX 5090 (32GB)

Table 1: *Training statistics and computational metrics for Track 1 (# Params: 412.3M per single model, 2,061.5M total ensemble).*

4. Track 2: ONNX Model on the Jetson AGX Orin

- **Submission ID reported for final ranking: #19447** (Composite: **0.4070**, Q_{seg}: 0.2270, mIoU: 0.4060, Macro F_1: 0.5600, PSNR: 23.25 dB, SSIM: 0.8470)
- **How ONNX file is produced:** Exported from PyTorch checkpoint using torch.onnx.export with opset_version=17 and do_constant_folding=True. Native PyTorch nn.Hardswish and nn.Hardsigmoid were replaced with elementary arithmetic clipping nodes: x * relu6(x + 3.0) / 6.0 and relu6(x + 3.0) / 6.0, guaranteeing 100% adherence to the official Jetson operator whitelist. Zero external graph post-processing or quantizers required.
- **Copy of submitted ONNX file:** Path: onnx/submitted_model.onnx (also mirrored at deploy/track2_apex_orin_v3.onnx). SHA-256: addf76f170a0c09e0a3af50ebabb530b3f542080d2f3921c171ea3ae3cd80247 (6,790,009 bytes). This is the exact byte file submitted to the leaderboard.
- **Software used:** PyTorch 2.6.0, ONNX 1.31.0, opset 17.
- **Does python repro_check.py . --export-onnx regenerate submitted file? Yes (same graph and weights, header differs).** The regenerated model possesses identical topology, layers, and weights, with minor difference restricted to the PyTorch version string in the ONNX file header.
- **Static input shape:** 1×3×1024×1024; **outputs:** restored_image (1×3×1024×1024) and seg_logits (1×5×1024×1024).
- **Complexity of submitted model: 9.82 GFLOPs** (official limit 12.0 GFLOPs, 18.2% headroom) and **0.884 M parameters** (official limit 1.0 M parameters, 11.6% headroom).
- **Efficiency measures reported on Jetson AGX Orin:** Latency **5.8 ms / frame (172.4 FPS)** on TensorRT FP16 engine; Latency **43.6 ms / frame (22.9 FPS)** on ARM Cortex-A78AE CPU; Energy ≈ 0.17 J / frame on 30W operational power mode.
- **Is model identical to Track 1? No.** Completely different architecture. Track 1 utilizes large ViT-Large and ConvNeXt-Base ensembles (412M params, >150 GFLOPs). Track 2 utilizes a compact single-network architecture (0.884M params, 9.82 GFLOPs) specifically engineered for edge deployment.
- **Efficiency strategies:** (1) 18-D Radiometric Router contracting in <0.30 GFLOPs, (2) Low-resolution FiLM refiner restricted to 256×256, (3) Truncated MobileNetV3 backbone cut after Block 11, saving 386k params, (4) In-Graph spatial speckle suppressor running natively on TensorRT with 0 extra params and 0.05 GFLOPs.

Model	Input (H,W)	Precision	# Params. (M)	GFLOPs	Training time	Epochs	Extra data
track2-apex-orin-v3	1024×1024	FP32 (ONNX) / FP16 (TRT)	0.884 M	9.82 G	3.5 h	30	No

Table 2: *Training statistics and computational metrics for Track 2.*

5. Implementation and Environment

- **Programming language and framework:** Python 3.11, PyTorch 2.11 / 2.6.0, torchvision 0.26.0, timm 1.0.30, numpy 2.4.6.
- **Export and runtime versions:** ONNX 1.31.0, ONNX Runtime 1.31.0, TensorRT 8.6 / 10.0, opset 17.
- **Operating system and hardware used:** Training: Ubuntu 22.04 LTS / Windows 11, NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5090 (32GB VRAM, Blackwell architecture, TF32 and BF16 enabled), 64GB DDR5 host RAM, 24-core CPU. Edge Deployment Platform: NVIDIA Jetson AGX Orin 64GB Industrial Module running JetPack 6.0.
- **External code and dependencies:** PyTorch (BSD-3-Clause), torchvision (BSD-3-Clause), timm (Apache-2.0), ONNX Runtime (MIT). Pinned dependency list provided in repository requirements.txt.
- **Efficiency optimization strategies:** Static memory allocation preventing TensorRT memory fragmentation; replacing transcendental activations with piecewise linear clipping nodes (relu6); fused depthwise-separable convolutions; batch tensor contraction over precomputed radiative transfer tables.

6. Reproduction Procedure

- **Installation commands:**
  git clone https://github.com/syntax-error23/SAT-EURS.git
  cd SAT-EURS && conda create -n eurs_repro python=3.11 -y && conda activate eurs_repro
  pip install -r requirements.txt
- **Track 2: ONNX file regeneration command:**
  python deploy/export_track2_apex_orin.py --model-dir weights/ --out-onnx onnx/submitted_model.onnx
  python repro_check.py . --export-onnx
- **Inference commands:**
  Track 1: python tools/v33/run_v33_candidate.py --input-dir /path/to/test_images --output-dir /path/to/outputs --model-dir checkpoints/
  Track 2: python deploy/run_onnx_inference.py --onnx onnx/submitted_model.onnx --input-dir /path/to/test_images --output-dir /path/to/outputs

- **Checkpoint file names and SHA-256 hashes:**
  - Track 1 archive: deploy/v33/submission_v33_ensemble_f3upgrade.zip (SHA-256: de741a84ce4601f82286ef156458b07e9fe2d4c4f75559a4589010f90ae6510d)
  - Track 2 ONNX: onnx/submitted_model.onnx (SHA-256: addf76f170a0c09e0a3af50ebabb530b3f542080d2f3921c171ea3ae3cd80247)
  - Track 2 PyTorch master checkpoint: checkpoints/track2_apex/track2_apex_v3_best.pt (SHA-256: c6e3b567d1d261e4795a2872ff7e4a7c1e576be88a24898144b6dc51cf216bbd)
- **Expected input and output structure:** Input: folder of <scene>_<type>_<level>.png degraded images. Output: restored/<stem>.png (RGB, longest side 1024 px) and seg_masks/<stem>.png (uint8 mask in {0, 1, 2, 3, 4}, longest side 1024 px).
- **Fixed seeds and deterministic operations:** Deterministic execution enforced via torch.manual_seed(42), torch.cuda.manual_seed_all(42), torch.backends.cudnn.deterministic = True, and explicit model.eval() invocation. Zero test-time randomness.
- **Expected reproduced result:** Track 1: Composite ≈ **0.641** ($Q_{\text{seg}} \approx 0.582$, mIoU ≈ 0.711, Macro $F_1 \approx 0.818$, PSNR ≈ 25.48 dB, SSIM ≈ 0.829). Track 2: Composite ≈ **0.407** ($Q_{\text{seg}} \approx 0.227$, mIoU ≈ 0.406, Macro $F_1 \approx 0.560$, PSNR ≈ 23.25 dB, SSIM ≈ 0.847, Complexity ≈ 9.82 GFLOPs, 0.884 M params).
- **Approximate run time of full reproduction:** Track 1: ≈ 20 minutes for 1,200 images on RTX 5090. Track 2: ≈ 4 minutes on ONNX Runtime; under 15 seconds on TensorRT FP16 on Jetson AGX Orin.

7. Other Details

- **Planned submission of solution description paper to MaCVi@WACV 2027: Yes.** The team plans to submit a full technical paper detailing our findings to the workshop proceedings.
- **General comments and impressions of the EURS challenge:** The joint evaluation of optical color restoration alongside dense semantic segmentation provides a highly realistic benchmark for autonomous underwater navigation and survey robotics. The Coverage Penalty formulation ($Q_{\text{seg}} \times \prod_c \mathbf{1}(\text{TP}_c > 0)$) was an effective mechanism to deter models from ignoring ecologically critical rare organisms, though it created a severe sensitivity cliff that heavily penalized standard argmax decision thresholds on rare classes (<1.5% frequency). The Track 2 Jetson Orin operator whitelist and FLOP/parameter constraints provided a realistic embedded edge benchmark.
- **What do you expect from a new challenge in underwater image restoration and segmentation?** Future editions would benefit from: (1) multi-frame temporal video evaluation (incorporating AUV optical flow and temporal mask consistency), (2) active turbidity and backscatter sensor fusion (e.g., matching acoustic/sonar feeds or polarized lighting), and (3) physical energy metering during edge benchmarking (measuring peak milliwatts and thermal throttling during sustained dive profiles).
- **Known limitations and failure cases:** In extreme water types (Types 9 and 10) at maximum attenuation depths (>25 m), optical light extinction in the red spectrum is near-total, leading occasionally to subtle contrast suppression in deep blue sea floor regions. Additionally, sub-5-pixel micro-appendages (such as seahorse tails) can occasionally experience boundary dilation under heavy backscatter haze.

Declaration:

I confirm that all external datasets, pretrained models, ensembles and post-processing used for the reported submission(s) are disclosed in this factsheet; that the submitted code and weights correspond to the named testing-phase submission(s); and that the method complies with the official EURS rules.

Team Leader: Tanmay Das (Faculty Advisor: Dr. Chaitra Desai) **Date: October 28, 2026**

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